Kentucky Summative Assessment (KSA)
Performance Level Descriptors (PLDs)
Grade 11

Science – Grade 11

Distinguished

A student performing at the Distinguished level for high school science consistently explains complex phenomena and designs solutions with depth, precision, and sophistication by integrating and applying science and engineering practices through the lens of crosscutting concepts. The student demonstrates clear, comprehensive understanding across the full range of core disciplinary science ideas for high school.

The distinguished student consistently asks insightful questions, defines and investigates complex problems, and develops and refines models of structures and processes—such as chemical reactions, inheritance and evolution, forces and motion, or climate systems—to predict and explain outcomes. The student consistently skillfully analyzes and interprets data, applying advanced mathematical, statistical, and computational reasoning, and constructs well-reasoned explanations and designs solutions that are supported by multiple sources of evidence. The student effectively engages in arguments from evidence and communicates scientific ideas with precision, using crosscutting concepts such as patterns, energy and matter, systems and system models, scale, proportion, structure and function, and stability and change to organize and connect ideas in sophisticated ways across scientific disciplines.

Proficient

A student performing at the Proficient level for high school science can usually explain complex phenomena and design solutions by integrating and applying science and engineering practices, often using crosscutting concepts to deepen understanding. The student applies these practices to demonstrate understanding clearly and effectively across most of the full range of core disciplinary science ideas for high school.

The proficient student often asks questions and defines problems and plans investigations that generate quantitative and qualitative data to explain cause-and-effect relationships, energy and matter flows, and system interactions. The student usually develops and uses models of structures and processes—such as atomic interactions and chemical reactions, genetic inheritance and evolution, forces and motion, or Earth system dynamics—and usually accurately analyzes and interprets data, applying mathematical, statistical, and computational thinking to identify patterns, make predictions, and connect evidence to scientific principles. The student often constructs explanations, designs and refines solutions, and engages in argument from evidence by evaluating, critiquing, and synthesizing multiple data sources to

support claims and communicate scientific

ideas, while considering scale, proportion, structure and function, and stability and change across disciplines.

Apprentice
A student performing at the Apprentice level for high school science demonstrates a partial understanding of science and engineering practices and applies them with limited accuracy or consistency. The student sometimes asks questions or defines problems, plans investigations, or develops and uses models, but does so at a basic level. Data analysis and interpretation may be incomplete, and explanations or solutions are often general or only partially supported by evidence.
A student at this level shows an emerging ability to apply practices to demonstrate partial understanding of some disciplinary core ideas for high school, such as Newton's laws, chemical reactions, inheritance of traits, or Earth system processes. Crosscutting concepts—such as patterns, energy and matter, systems and system models, scale, and stability and change—are beginning to be used but in a basic, limited, or occasionally inaccurate way.

Novice
A student performing at the Novice level for high school science demonstrates minimal understanding of science and engineering practices and has difficulty applying them appropriately. The student rarely asks questions, defines problems, plans investigations, or develops and uses models in meaningful ways, and rarely applies mathematics or computational thinking to analyze data. Explanations and solutions are often incomplete, inaccurate, or lack evidence, and attempts at argument from evidence or communication of ideas are limited.
A student at this level does not or rarely applies practices to demonstrate understanding of disciplinary core ideas for high school. Crosscutting concepts such as patterns, energy and matter, systems and system models, or stability and change are seldom used, and when attempted, are often applied inaccurately. Misconceptions about major scientific concepts are common.

Social Studies – Grade 11

Distinguished
A student performing at the Distinguished level has a comprehensive understanding of the concepts and practices described in the Kentucky Academic Standards for Social Studies, grades 9–12. The student consistently demonstrates advanced insight into civics, economics, geography, and history in past and present-day state, national, and global settings. The student is adept in using inquiry practices.

Examples of the knowledge and skills expected of a student performing at the Distinguished level include the ability to:

1. Synthesize complex information about citizenship and/or government
2. Consistently apply micro- and macroeconomic concepts and analyze the impacts of economic choices
3. Apply geographic reasoning to analyze humans' interactions with each other and their environment
4. Critically evaluate factors that influenced historical events
5. Interpret and integrate evidence from multiple complex sources, such as primary and secondary texts, maps, graphs, tables, and images
6. Effectively apply appropriate evidence to construct claims and counterclaims in response to compelling and supporting questions
7. Clearly and effectively construct sophisticated arguments, explanations, and solutions to problems using relevant evidence that shows respect for diverse opinions

Proficient

A student performing at the Proficient level has a broad understanding of the concepts and practices described in the Kentucky Academic Standards for Social Studies, grades 9–12. The student demonstrates appropriate insight into civics, economics, geography, and history in past and present-day state, national, and global settings. The student shows adequate skills using inquiry practices.

Examples of the knowledge and skills expected of a student performing at the Proficient level include the ability to:

1. Analyze information about citizenship and/or government
2. Often apply micro- and macroeconomic concepts and analyze the impacts of economic choices
3. Use geographic reasoning to describe humans' interactions with each other and their environment
4. Analyze factors that influenced historical events
5. Interpret evidence from complex sources, such as primary and secondary texts, maps, graphs, tables, and images
6. Apply appropriate evidence to construct claims and counterclaims in response to compelling and supporting questions
7. Effectively construct arguments, explanations, and solutions to problems using relevant evidence that shows respect for diverse opinions

Apprentice
A student performing at the Apprentice level has a basic understanding of the concepts and practices described in the Kentucky Academic Standards for Social Studies, grades 9–12. The student sometimes demonstrates insight into civics, economics, geography, and history in past and present-day state, national, and global settings. The student has moderate skill using inquiry practices.

Examples of the knowledge and skills demonstrated by a student performing at the Apprentice level include the ability to:

1. Explain information about citizenship and/or government
2. Describe micro- and macroeconomic concepts and make economic choices
3. Explain basic geographic concepts and use basic geographic skills
4. Explain factors that influenced historical events
5. Use evidence from simple sources, such as secondary texts, maps, graphs, tables, and images
6. Apply evidence to construct claims in response to compelling and supporting questions
7. Construct arguments and explanations using relevant evidence

Novice
A student performing at the Novice level has a beginning understanding of the concepts and practices described in the Kentucky Academic Standards for Social Studies, grades 9–12. The student occasionally demonstrates insight into civics, economics, geography, and history in past and present-day state, national, and global settings. The student has emerging skills using inquiry practices.

Examples of the knowledge and skills demonstrated by a student performing at the Novice level include the ability to:

1. Recall basic facts about citizenship and/or government
2. Recall simple economic concepts
3. Use basic geographic skills
4. Identify factors that influenced historical events
5. Locate basic information in simple sources, such as secondary texts and maps
6. Create claims in response to compelling and supporting questions
7. Construct explanations with evidence that has limited relevance

Editing & Mechanics – Grade 11

Distinguished
A student performing at the distinguished performance level for grade 11 Editing and Mechanics consistently demonstrates firm control over of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation and spelling as well as intentional and effective use of diction, syntax, and rhetoric. The student is adept at determining and clarifying the meaning of nuanced words and phrases and routinely demonstrates an extensive vocabulary across interdisciplinary literacy, including figurative language, denotations and connotations.

Proficient
A student performing at the Proficient performance level for grade 11 Editing and Mechanics often demonstrates firm control over of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation and spelling as well as intentional and effective use of diction, syntax, and rhetoric. The student usually determines and clarifies the meaning of nuanced words and phrases and often demonstrates an extensive vocabulary across interdisciplinary literacy, including figurative language, denotations and connotations.

Apprentice
A student performing at the Apprentice performance level for grade 11 Editing and Mechanics sometimes demonstrates firm control over of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation and spelling as well as intentional and effective use of diction, syntax, and rhetoric. The student attempts to determine and clarify the meaning of nuanced words and phrases and demonstrates a basic vocabulary across interdisciplinary literacy, including figurative language, denotations and connotations.

Novice
A student performing at the Novice performance level for grade 11 Editing and Mechanics minimally demonstrates control over of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation and spelling as well as intentional and effective use of diction, syntax, and rhetoric. The student rarely determines and clarifies the meaning of nuanced words and phrases and demonstrates a minimal vocabulary across interdisciplinary literacy, including figurative language, denotations and connotations.

On-Demand Writing – Grade 11

Distinguished

A student performing at the distinguished performance level for grade 11 Writing skillfully composes an argumentative piece using resources to support claims and provide valid reasoning and relevant evidence. The student thoroughly demonstrates clarity and coherence by providing precise, knowledgeable claims; clearly establishing the significance of the claims; and addressing all demands of the prompt. The student skillfully acknowledges and distinguishes counterclaims and thoroughly counters and refutes opposing claims with carefully selected evidence. The student fairly and thoroughly develops and supports claims with insightful reasoning and carefully selected relevant evidence that strengthens the argument and provides thorough and effective explanations of evidence and ideas and complex reasoning to clarify nuances of the claims. The student consistently includes the most relevant evidence for each claim, identifying the strengths and limitations and anticipating the audience's knowledge and perspective. The student skillfully uses a minimum of two provide sources to support the claims and consistently and thoroughly cites evidence by quoting and/or paraphrasing details, examples, and ideas. The student effectively demonstrates organization with sophisticated structure; skillfully sequenced claims, reasoning, and evidence to strengthen the argument; consistent use of a variety of effective words, phrases, clauses, syntax; and a logical, thorough conclusion that clearly solidifies the argument. The student consistently demonstrates effective use of language and conventions, including a sophisticated formal tone or voice, effective and varied word choice, and skillful use of conventions of Standard English with few minor errors that do not interfere with understanding of the writin

Proficient

A student performing at the Proficient performance level for grade 11 Writing effectively composes an argumentative piece using resources to support claims and provide valid reasoning and relevant evidence. The student demonstrates clarity and coherence by providing precise and knowledgeable claims and addressing all demands of the prompt. The student acknowledges, distinguishes, counters, and refutes claims. The student develops claims fairly and thoroughly with logical reasoning and relevant evidence, provides the most relevant evidence, and includes reasoning that points out the strengths and limitations of claims. The student accurately and effectively uses a minimum of two provided sources to support the claims and effectively cites evidence by quoting and/or paraphrasing details, examples, and ideas. The student demonstrates organization by providing clear structure; logical sequenced claims; effective words, phrases, clauses, varied syntax; and a logical conclusion. The student effectively demonstrates use of language and conventions by including an appropriate formal tone or voice, appropriate word choice, and use of conventions of Standard English with minor errors that do not interfere with understanding the writing.

Apprentice

A student performing at the Apprentice performance level for grade 11 Writing attempts to compose an argumentative piece using resources to support claims and provide valid reasoning and relevant evidence. The student attempts clarity and coherence by making general claims that address the prompt and attempting to address some of the demands of the prompt. The student attempts to acknowledge, counter, and refute opposing claims. The student attempts to support the claims with evidence, providing vague and/or general explanations and reasoning. The student uses a minimum of two provided sources to attempt to support the claims and inconsistently cites evidence using quotes and/or paraphrasing details, examples, and ideas. The student attempts basic organization, structure, and conclusion. The student uses simple or infrequent words, phrases, and clauses to link sections of the text. The student attempts to demonstrate use of language and conventions, including weak formal tone or voice and word choice. The student makes frequent errors in using conventions of Standard English which interfere with understanding the writing.

Novice

A student performing at the Novice performance level for grade 11 Writing ineffectively composes an argumentative piece using resources to support claims and provide valid reasoning and relevant evidence. The student is unable to demonstrate clarity and coherence due to unclear claims and missing all demands of the prompt. The student includes ineffective or no attempt to acknowledge, counter, or refute opposing claims. The student includes minimal or no purposeful support of claims; incomplete, inaccurate, and/or irrelevant explanations of evidence and ideas; and minimal or unrelated reasoning. The student uses one or none of the provided sources or ineffectively uses a minimum of two provided sources to support the claims; cites little or no evidence; and includes little or no quotes and/or paraphrasing of details, examples, and ideas. The student includes minimal or no organization, structure, transitions, or conclusion to support the argument. The student is unable to use language and conventions effectively, including lack of appropriate formal tone or voice and simple or inappropriate word choice. The student makes significant errors in conventions of Standard English which interfere with understanding of the writing.

Combined Writing Performance Level – Grade 11

		On Demand Writing			
		N	**A**	**P**	**D**
Editing and Mechanics	**D**	A	P	P	D
	P	A	A	P	D
	A	N	A	P	P
	N	N	A	A	P